

Gaurav Khanna

School of Global Policy and Strategy, University of California – San Diego
gakhanna@ucsd.edu | www.econgaaurav.com

Employment

Associate Professor of Economics, School of Global Policy and Strategy (GPS), University of California San Diego	<i>2024–present</i>
Assistant Professor of Economics, GPS, University of California San Diego	<i>2017–2024</i>
Consultant, The World Bank, Washington, DC	<i>2009–2010</i>

Professional Affiliations and Service

Editor, *Journal of Labor Economics*
Associate Editor, *Journal of Development Economics*
Research Associate, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)
Affiliate, Bureau for Research and Economic Analysis of Development (BREAD)
Affiliate, Yale Research Initiative on Innovation and Scale (Y-RISE)
Non-Resident Fellow, Center for Global Development

Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
M.Sc., Economics for Development, University of Oxford
B.A. (Honors), Economics, St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi

Selected Publications

"From Asia, With Skills", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, forthcoming.

"Abundance from Abroad: Migrant Income and Long-Run Economic Development" (with Caroline Theoharides and Dean Yang), *American Economic Review*, forthcoming.

"Traditional Institutions in Modern Times: Dowries as Pensions When Sons Migrate" (with Natalie Bau, Corinne Low, and Alessandra Voena), *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, Vol 141(1), February 2026, 205–262.

"Brain Drain or Brain Gain? Effects of High-Skilled International Emigration on Origin Countries" (with Catia Batista, Daniel Han, Johannes Haushofer, David McKenzie, Ahmed Mushfiq Mobarak, Caroline Theoharides, and Dean Yang), *Science* 388 (2024): eadr8861.

"The Aggregate Implications of Cultural Proximity" (with Brian Cevallos Fujiy and Hiroshi Toma), *European Economic Review*, Volume 179, October 2025

"Native-Refugee Education Gaps" (with Cevat Giray Aksoy, Victoria Marino, and Semih Tumen), *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, vol. 115, May 2025 (pp. 427–31)

“The Productivity Consequences of Pollution-Induced Migration in China” (with Wenquan Liang, A. Mushfiq Mobarak, and Ran Song), *AEJ: Applied Economics* 17(2), April 2025.

“Extending the Social Safety Net: Female Labor Supply and Rural Pension Eligibility in Brazil” (with Margaret Lay, Stephanie Lee, and Benjamin Thompson), *Journal of Public Economics* 245 (2025): 105352.

“Migration Policy and the Supply of Foreign Physicians: Evidence from the Conrad 30 Waiver Program” (with Breno Braga and Sarah Turner), *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* 226 (Oct 2024): 106682.

“Trade Liberalization and Chinese Students in US Higher Education” (with Kevin Shih, Ariel Weinberger, Mingzhi Xu, and Miaojie Yu), *Review of Economics and Statistics*, Oct 2023.

“Formal Employment and Organized Crime: Regression Discontinuity Evidence from Colombia” (with Carlos Medina, Anant Nyshadham, and Jorge Tamayo), *Economic Journal*, Apr 2023.

“Political Accountability for Populist Policies: Lessons from India’s Demonetization” (with Priya Mukherjee), *Journal of Public Economics* 219 (2023): 104819.

“Large-Scale Education Reform in General Equilibrium: Regression Discontinuity Evidence from India,” *Journal of Political Economy* 131(2) (2023).

“Women’s Well-Being During a Pandemic and its Containment” (with Natalie Bau, Corinne Low, Manisha Shah, Sreyashi Sharmin and Alessandra Voena), *Journal of Development Economics* 156 (2022): 102839.

“Job Loss, Credit and Crime in Colombia” (with Carlos Medina, Anant Nyshadham, Christian Posso and Jorge Tamayo), *American Economic Review: Insights* 3(1) (2021): 97–114.

“The Globalization of Postsecondary Education: The Role of International Students in the US Higher Education System” (with John Bound, Breno Braga and Sarah Turner), *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 35(1) (2021).

“A Passage to America: International Students in US Universities” (with John Bound, Breno Braga and Sarah Turner), *AEJ: Economic Policy* 12(1) (2020).

“Does Affirmative Action Incentivize Schooling? Evidence from India,” *Review of Economics and Statistics* 102(2) (2020): 219–233.

“Resource Accumulation, Conflict, and the Development of Africa” (with Achyuta Adhvaryu, James Fenske and Anant Nyshadham), *Journal of Development Economics* 149 (2021): 102598.

“Guns and Butter? Fighting Violence with the Promise of Development” (with Laura Zimmermann), *Journal of Development Economics* 124 (2017): 120–141.

“Reservoir of Foreign Talent” (with John Bound and Nicolas Morales), *Science* 356 (2017): 697.

“Recruitment of Foreigners in the Market for Computer Scientists in the US” (with John Bound, Breno Braga and Joseph Golden), *Journal of Labor Economics* 33 (2015).

Working Papers

“The IT Sector Boom and Other Unintended Consequences of Chasing the American Dream” (with Nicolas Morales), Revise & Resubmit, *American Economic Review*.

“Spatial Mobility, Economic Opportunity, and Crime” (with Carlos Medina, Anant Nyshadham, Daniel Ramos, Jorge Tamayo and Audrey Tiew), Revise & Resubmit, *American Economic Review*.

“Production Networks and Firm-Level Elasticities of Substitution” (with Brian Cevallos Fujiy and Devaki Ghose).

“Hometown Conflict and Refugees’ Integration Efforts” (with Cevat Giray Aksoy, Victoria Marino and Semih Tumen), Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of the European Economic Association*.

“Supply Chain Resilience: Evidence from Indian Firms” (with Nicolas Morales and Nitya Pandalai-Nayar), Revise & Resubmit, *AEJ: Macroeconomics*.

“Shared Identity and Entrepreneurship” (with Manaswini Bhalla, Ishani Chatterjee and Manisha Goel), Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*.

“The Road Oft Taken: Highways to Spatial Development.”

“Endogenous Production Networks and Firm Dynamics” (with Anuraag Aekka).

“Weathering the Storm: Supply Chains and Climate Risk” (with Juanma Castro-Vincenzi, Nicolas Morales and Nitya Pandalai-Nayar).

“The Ripple Effects of China’s College Expansion on American Universities” (with Ruixue Jia, Hongbin Li, and Yuli Xu), Under Revision, *Economic Journal*.

“Gender Pay Gaps in the Social Sciences” (with Ayelet Gneezy, Uri Gneezy, Joshua Graff Zivin, Elizabeth Lyons, and Marta Serra-Garcia), Under Revision, *PNAS*.

“Love in the Time of Zika” (with C. Austin Davis, Maddison Erbabian, and Margaret Lay).

Other Publications and Chapters

“Understanding the Economic Impact of the H-1B Program on the US” (with John Bound and Nicolas Morales), in *High-Skilled Migration to the United States and Its Economic Consequences*, NBER.

“Public Universities: The Supply Side of Building a Skilled Workforce” (with John Bound, Breno Braga and Sarah Turner), *RSF Journal of the Social Sciences* (2019).

“Fighting Maoist Violence with Promises: Evidence from India’s Employment Guarantee Scheme” (with Laura Zimmermann), *Economics of Peace and Security Journal* 9(1) (2014).

“High-Skill Immigration, Innovation, and Creative Destruction” (with Munseob Lee), in *The Role of Immigrants and Foreign Students in Science, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship*.

“Finishing Degrees and Finding Jobs: U.S. Higher Education and the Flow of Foreign IT Workers” (with John Bound, Murat Demirci and Sarah Turner), in *NBER Innovation, Policy and the Economy* (2014).

“Fewer Jobs or Smaller Paychecks? Aggregate Crisis Impacts in Selected Middle-Income Countries” (with David Newhouse and Pierella Paci), IZA Working Paper; in *Working Through the Crisis* (2013).

“How Higher Education Became an Important US Export,” *Issues in Science and Technology* (2021).

“Better Migrant Rights Helps Native Workers,” *Journal of International Law and Foreign Affairs* (2020).

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

NBER Supply Chain Resilience Project (cancelled), 2025–2026
Y-RISE Workforce Development Initiative Grant, 2023–2026
World Bank Gender and Innovation Lab Grant, 2023–2026
Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation (IGCC), Security and Climate Change, 2023–2024
Center for Global Transformation Fellow, 2022–2023
Hellman Fellowship, UC San Diego, 2021–2022
GLM|LIC Grant on Covid and Gender, 2021
NBER Fellowship for Economics of High-Skill Immigration, Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, 2015–2016
Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship, University of Michigan, 2015–2016
Michael Moore Dissertation Prize (Applied Microeconomics), University of Michigan, 2015
MITRE Research Fellowship Award, University of Michigan, 2012–2014
James A. Miller Scholarship, University of Michigan, 2010–2015
Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor (nominated), University of Michigan, 2012, 2013
Distinction in Microeconomics and Development Economics, University of Michigan, 2011, 2012
George Webb Medley Prize for Best Overall Performance, Oxford University, 2009
Felix Scholarship, Oxford University, 2008–2009

Selected Media & Op-Eds

For a complete list, see:

[Media Page](#) | [Op-Eds, Blogs, and Podcasts](#)

Last updated: January 2026